If you don’t want to write plain JSON or YAML to create templates for your infrastructure, a few alternatives to CloudFormation exist.

The AWS Cloud Development Kit (CDK) (https://aws.amazon.com/cdk/) allows you to use a general-purpose programming language to define your infrastructure. Under the hood, the CDK generates CloudFormation templates.

Another popular option is Terraform (https://www.terraform.io), which supports AWS as well as other cloud and service providers.

When you changed the parameter, CloudFormation figured out what needed to be done to achieve the end result. That’s the power of a declarative approach: you say what the end result should look like, not how the end result should be achieved.



Cleaning up

Delete the stack by selecting it and clicking the Delete button.

Summary

- Use the CLI, one of the SDKs, or CloudFormation to automate your infrastructure on AWS.
- Infrastructure as Code describes the approach of programming the creation and modification of your infrastructure, including virtual machines, networking, storage, and more.
- You can use the CLI to automate complex processes in AWS with scripts (Bash and PowerShell).
- You can use SDKs for nine programming languages and platforms to embed AWS into your applications and create applications like nodecc.